

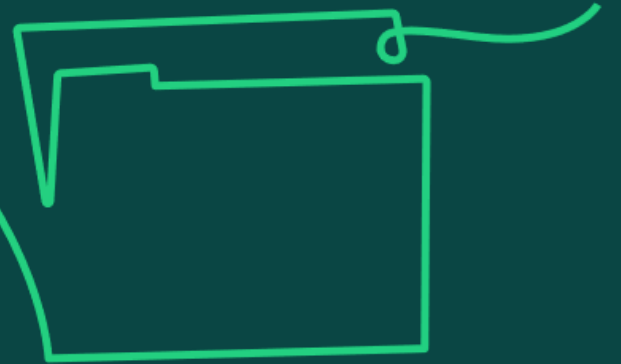
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Integrated planning

Learning objective:

19. Understand integrated planning as the ability to incorporate multiple plans and processes into an integrated project management plan.

19a) Know the format for an effective integrated project management plan and its typical contents.



An effective integrated project management plan

The intention of the project management plan (PMP) is to capture the fundamental components to deliver project outcomes successfully.

- It involves collating a suite of plans and processes to support a project to create an integrated plan (the PMP).
- The size and complexity of a project will influence the amount of content in the PMP.
- Format may also vary based on complexity, ways of working and who's involved in the project.
- Once the information is assembled in a self-contained document, it pulls together all the essential management processes needed to show the project teams' intentions of how the project will be managed.



Photo credit: Brands&People

Typical contents of a project management plan

The PMP details the why, what, when, who, how much, where and how of the project.

Benefits – why?

Referencing the business case, looking at the value the project benefits will deliver the business once achieved.

Time – when?

Showing the timeline for project activities and deliverables aligned to the project life cycle approach.

Scope – what?

Looking at descriptions of the scope involved, considering the product breakdown structure (PBS) and work breakdown structure (WBS) and detailing the acceptance criteria.

Cost – how much?

Showing how the budget has been allocated to the work for the project duration – the cost breakdown structure (CBS).

Resources – who?

Showing the roles and responsibilities and reporting lines – the organisational breakdown structure (OBS).

Management – how?

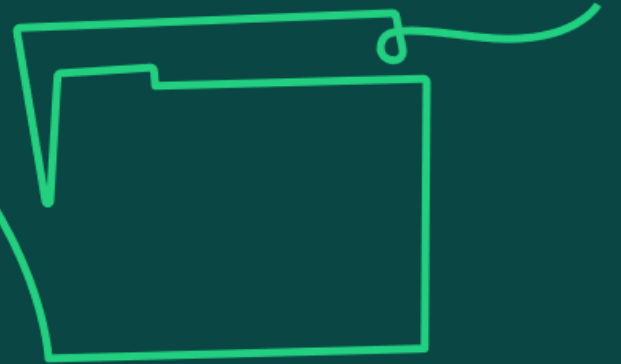
The most wide-ranging part of the document outlining the management aspects for deployment covering areas such as quality, risk and issues, communication and project controls.

Delivery logistics – where?

Detailing project location, delivery requirements, any environment constraints, technology to support virtual locations, or security protocols.

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19b) Understand the importance of producing an integrated project management plan.



Why is an integrated project management plan important?

- It communicates the details of approved project plans to stakeholders.
- Key stakeholders involved in the deployment of the project have been engaged with its production.
- It's a reference source for all stakeholders.
- It provides one source of the truth to all resources involved and can be used as induction material for new members, providing continuity to the project.
- It's referred to as the contract between the project manager and project sponsor, providing clarity on what is expected of the project manager.
- It guides the project team and is the baseline for measurement and analysis of progress to take place.